

# **Election Manifesto**

In June 1989, the citizens of the European Community will be electing their members to the European Parliament. With these elections, the citizens of the Community will be taking an important decision on the future of Europe. Today we are facing the challenges of the 'nineties: the completion of the internal market, the worldwide achievement of freedom and human rights, new opportunities in the field of disarmament and detente, the Issue of transfrontier environmental damage as well as the just division of the goods of the world.

We Christian Democrats in the European People's Party face these duties and challenges based on a Christian understanding of the person and their responsibility before God. Peace in freedom, solidarity and justice are the foundations on which we want to build a united Europe. We want a Europe based on the rule of law and the principles of law and democracy, where everyone develops his or her personality by taking responsibility for their neighbour. We want to see human rights respected, not only in free Europe, but throughout the world.

## **European unification will safeguard our future**

Only a Europe which speaks with one voice can bring its whole weight to its political and economic responsibilities in the world and make its contribution to overcoming the division of Europe. Only by developing its internal market and becoming an economic and technological community can it be successful on world markets. Only in a united Europe can there be true solidarity with the less developed regions and people in need. Only a united Europe can protect its natural environment and rehabilitate it. Only a European Community which comes together to form a security union can in the long term guarantee peace, justice and freedom in Europe, be an equal partner in the Atlantic Alliance and be a factor for peace in the world. Only a strong and self-confident Europe is capable of meeting its commitments to the people of the Third World on development cooperation.

## **OUR GOALS**

### **We want to safeguard prosperity and employment in Europe.**

An effective economic system, responsive to its social duties and to the needs of the environment, which allows the free development of market forces, is the best way to meet Europe's needs of today and tomorrow and to create new jobs.

The completion of the internal market, with the removal of frontiers for people, goods, services and capital provides its essential basis.

With the European internal market and the European social area, the creation of the currency union and the development of the research and technology community, we are developing the European Community to a modern, achievement oriented and human economic unit.

We want to strengthen personal responsibility as well as the participation of all regions and people and in the social and economic progress. We want to practice social partnership and improve living and working conditions in the countries of the Community.

We are in favour of an agricultural policy in which the family farm can assure a supply of healthy food for everyone, without damage to the environment.

### **We want to safeguard the natural environment**

Damage to the environment does not stop at frontiers; therefore environmental protection must be international. In Europe, we want high level Community environmental standards, and, beyond the frontiers of the European Community, to work closely with our neighbours and world wide.

We pursue active policies to keep air, ground and water clean. Protection of the environment and economic development are not in conflict, rather they belong together. The objective of our policy is to harmonise technical and economic progress with the capacity and powers of endurance of the fundamentals of natural life.

Our commitment to the protection of the environment is part of our Christian understanding of respect for the person.

### **We want to create a citizens' Europe**

We want a Europe which will give European citizens the chance to live, work and study in other countries, when the frontier posts have been taken away.

As many young people as possible should have the chance of acquiring knowledge and experience in other EEC countries. Work experience as well as diplomas must be recognised mutually. We want citizens who work and live in another EEC country to have equality of treatment in labour law and social security.

We want a Europe of the citizens, in which there is a real right to security. Therefore the European Community must improve its common policy for dealing with terrorism, crime and drug trafficking.

### **We want to safeguard peace in freedom and justice.**

The European Community is a community of values, based on common convictions: on the principle of democracy, the rule of law, the freedom of the person, social justice and universal respect for human rights.

We want a common foreign and security policy which serves the cause of détente in the world and safeguards peace and freedom in Europe and the world.

For us, an active peace policy is a political necessity and a moral duty.

We Christian Democrats support arms control and disarmament, so that military equilibrium and greater political stability can be achieved.

We want to continue to improve foreign and security policy cooperation In European Political cooperation and In the Western European Union and thus to strengthen the Atlantic Alliance and Europe's role in the world.

### **We want to meet our responsibility in the World**

The European Community must contribute all its political and economic weight in International politics and play a mediating role in the world.

The only way to achieve stability and peace In the world Is by a North-south policy, which takes on the struggle against hunger and for justice, which offers opportunities of fair trade, which offers opportunities for development to people and to states and which defends human rights.

Environmental problems in the developing countries have a world wide impact. Therefore we want a common effort to deal with the greenhouse effect, desertification and the destruction of forests. The export of chemical waste to the third world must be forbidden.

### **We want more democracy in the European Community**

The Single European Act has significantly increased the responsibility and powers of the European Community. The European Parliament now cooperates In many important legislative areas, beyond its previous surveillance and budgetary powers.

We want to develop further the rights of the parliament. The citizens of the Community do not want less democracy in the Community than they have at home. Therefore the Community needs a strong and operational parliament which effectively represents the citizen in legislation and in the surveillance of a responsible government. By taking part in these elections they are making the European Parliament the central force of future European unification. Our goal Is the United States of Europe.

### **Christian Democrats build Europe**

At a critical time It was the Christian Democrats who provided the impulse towards European unity. In creating the European Community, Christian Democrats created a model for all Europe, a lasting order of peace in freedom. In this tradition, the EPP will in the future also be a driving force for European unification.

We, Christian Democrats play a key role in the European Parliament. We are asking to be entrusted with the task of bringing Europe to the threshold of the 21st Century. We are presenting ourselves to the voters and asking them for their trust in our policies and for our candidates.

With solidarity and effectiveness

On the people's side EUROPEAN PEOPLE'S PART